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THE MONTHLY NEWSLETTER FOR RESIDENTS OF THE MPII CDD

MPII NEWS



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Meadow Pointe II Clubhouse

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813-991-5016

clubhouse@mpiicdd.org
www.meadowpointe2cdd.org
Facebook.com/MPIICDD

Operations Manager

Justin Wright
justinwright@mpiicdd.org

Office Hours

Daily 8am—8:45pm

Fitness Center

M-F 7am—8:45pm
S/S 8am—8:45pm

Pool

Daily 9am—30 minutes before dusk

Playground

Daily 9am—30 minutes before dusk

Courts

Daily 8am—8:45pm



While many in our area complain about all the growth and development, one of the great things about living in MPII is the amount of nature that was *kept* within our community. Lots of woods, conservation areas, and over 100 ponds make MPII a beautiful neighborhood—for human as well as animal residents. *Photo courtesy of Vicki Teter.*

MPII CDD Board of Supervisors

John Picarelli
Chairperson
johnpicarelli@mpiicdd.org

Jamie Childers
Vice Chairperson
jchilders@mpiicdd.org

Nicole Darner
Secretary
nicoledarner@mpiicdd.org

Rob Signoretti
Secretary
robertsignoretti@mpiicdd.org

Kyle Molder
Secretary
kyle.molder@mpiicdd.org

The CDD Board of Supervisors holds public meetings twice each month. These are held on the 1st and 3rd Wednesdays at 6:30 pm in the Clubhouse.

All MPII residents are welcomed and encouraged to attend. This is your CDD and attending meetings is the best way to stay informed and share your input.

Hurricane Milton

The Tampa Bay area, specifically Wesley Chapel, has avoided the brunt of most tropical storms and hurricanes for years. Unfortunately, Milton ended that run. Hurricane Milton made landfall near Sarasota at approximately 8:30 pm on Wednesday, October 9th. It then roared northeast across Florida just south of us and out into the Atlantic. Early estimates were that Milton did 100 billion dollars in damage as it crossed the peninsula.

However, MPII was well prepared. A few residents evacuated, but most stayed. A few residents boarded or shuttered up, but most didn't. Nearly all residents did their part to bring in all items that could cause problems for their own homes or their neighbors. Everything from Halloween décor to lanai furniture was either tied down, put in pools, or brought indoors to reduce the risks.

Most residents were prepared with plenty of food, a safety plan, and all the resources they would need (medicines, generators, batteries, water, etc.). You all did great work preparing and getting ready.

Partially due to your efforts, and with a touch of good luck, MPII once again eluded catastrophic damage. Yes, many trees and plants were lost. Sure, many fences and sheds were damaged. Some screened areas were damaged. Some roofs will need repair or replacement. But, compared to many areas near us, we weathered the storm well. Some sections of MPII lost power, some never lost power.

More importantly, our community should be very proud of their response during and after Milton. The Clubhouse staff witnessed countless instances of neighbors helping neighbors. Residents moving downed branches out of the streets. Hundreds of social media posts offering help or sharing awareness of resources available or nearby hazards to be avoided.

Justin Wright, our Clubhouse Operations Manager, and John Picarelli, the Chair of our CDD Board, were also out at...

Hurricane Milton continues on page 4...

Monthly MPII Trivia

Trivia – What song, now *thought of* as a Christmas song, was actually written as a *Thanksgiving* song?

Answer on page 4.

DST and Safety

Daylight Saving Time (DST) ends this month, on November 3rd. While there are efforts to eliminate DST from American timekeeping standards, for now it is still with us, so we all have to account for it. One of the reasons that many people are lobbying for an end to DST is the myriad adverse effects on health, safety, and wellness. Since it is still part of our lives, it can be beneficial to be aware of the dangerous effects and perhaps more importantly, what you can do to minimize or eliminate these issues.

According to countless experts, including the CDC and Johns Hopkins, DST has a statistically significant heightened risk of mood disturbances and hospital admissions. DST shift periods (the days following the time adjustment) create an elevated production of inflammatory markers in response to stress. A 2020 study showed a 6% increase in fatal traffic accidents during the shift periods. The altered sleep patterns created by DST also create higher percentages of workplace accidents during shift periods. Also, even a subtle disturbance to people's sleep cycles can adversely affect their general health and weaken their ability to recover from routine illnesses and injuries.

The good news is that there are things we can do to help ourselves adjust more easily. Sleep experts suggest shifting your bedtime and waking time by 15 minutes each night for four nights leading into DST time changes. Of course, this is more effective if you keep regular bedtimes to start with. Also, try to ensure that you get a proper amount of sleep each night all year long.

Another thing we can all do is to try to reduce the instances of risky or dangerous tasks for several days after the time change. In other words, if you are able to (as a worker, an employer, or just in your personal life) schedule any activities that already present a danger to not occur near DST you could prevent accidents and maybe even save a life. For example, if there is a work project or home chore that involves a long drive/road trip or extended ladder time – schedule those more than one week prior to or after the time change.

Additionally, sometimes just being cognizant of the heightened risks associated with DST can cause people to be more mindful when working or performing tasks near a DST time change. That alone can reduce the risk. The bottom line is that DST does affect us, perhaps more than we realize. An increased awareness, and a minor effort at altering our sleep routine could make us a lot safer. Stay safe, healthy, and well MPII.

https://blogs.cdc.gov/niosh-science-blog/2022/03/08/time-change/
https://publichealth.jhu.edu/2023/7-things-to-know-about-daylight-saving-time

MPII Management Company

Inframark
Jayna Cooper
Jayna.Cooper@inframark.com
813-608-8242

CDD fee/Bond Questions

Inframark Accounting Department
954-603-0033

The MPII Clubhouse offers MPII residents Notary Services at no cost.

We have a certified Notary on staff, please call ahead for availability.

Hurricane Milton

Continued from page 2

dawn the morning after Milton assessing MPII and beginning the process of recovery. Justin and several members of the Clubhouse maintenance staff spent the day prioritizing the needs of MPII and clearing debris. The Clubhouse itself reopened on Friday 10/11 after the storm and was available for residents that still didn't have power to recharge devices, or simply enjoy a little AC and get out of the house for a break.

By the time you read this, most residents will have fully recovered from Milton. And the reason is the soul of our community. You all prepared, you endured, you helped each other after the storm. Well done MPII. Hopefully we won't see another storm like this for many years. But if we do, it's nice to know this community will rise to the challenge before, during, and after the emergency. Stay safe MPII. Well done.

Election Day 2024

The November General Election is here – it's Tuesday, November 5th! If you're an MPII resident, then the MPII Clubhouse is your local polling place. If you still plan to vote early, locations can be found at www.pascovotes.gov. If you plan to vote by mail, the deadline has passed to obtain a ballot, but completed ballots must be received by 11/5. However, if you're voting in person on Election Day, the Clubhouse will be open as a polling location from 7 am – 7 pm. If you're coming out to vote, please be patient with the poll workers, your fellow voters, and any wait times you have.

Due to the election, the Clubhouse and all amenities will be closed – being physically open only for polling. Whether you're voting on Election Day or not, please be aware that there will be a significant increase in traffic (vehicle and pedestrian) in the vicinity of the Clubhouse. Please be patient and extra cautious when driving anywhere near the intersection of Mansfield Boulevard and County Line Road.

High turnout is expected as this is the Presidential election, in addition to numerous state and local positions. Also, two of the five CDD Board of Supervisor seats are up for election on this ballot, where Rob Signoretti and Christopher Kluender are each running unopposed. All CDD Board seats are for four-year terms.

We encourage all qualified MPII residents to exercise their right to vote, to be kind and patient with the poll workers, and to be respectful of your fellow community members. Let's all remember that while political issues and candidates can be divisive, it's critical that we all remember we are neighbors first. Let's be a shining example of a kind and good community, even when we don't all agree. And let's have yet another great voter turnout within MPII!

Trivia Answer (from page 2): Jingle Bells!

One Horse Open Sleigh, now known as Jingle Bells, was written by James Lord Pierpont in 1850 as a Thanksgiving song for his father's Sunday school class.

https://www.southernliving.com/holidays-occasions/christmas/jingle-bells-not-christmas-carol

November Holidays



1st – Diwali. Today is Diwali – the Hindu Festival of Lights. It is celebrated by Hindus, Jains, Sikhs, and some Buddhists. Using light as a metaphor for knowledge and consciousness, the festival celebrates the victory of light over dark, good over evil, and knowledge over ignorance. To all those that celebrate, have a very Happy Diwali!



November 1st – All Saints' Day/All Souls' Day. Many Christians celebrate all of the Saints on November 1st, and on the 2nd they commemorate the faithful that have departed. To all the Christians who celebrate these holidays: Have a Blessed All Saints' Day and All Souls' Day!



November 3rd – Daylight Saving Time Ends. At 2am on Sunday, November 3rd (or Saturday night before bed for most people), clocks need to be set back one hour as we return to Eastern Standard Time. Don't forget watches and car clocks! Hopefully everyone enjoys the extra hour of sleep!



November 11th – Veterans Day. While WWI wouldn't officially end until June 28, 1919, the fighting ceased with an armistice on the 11th hour of the 11th day of the 11th month of 1918. One year later, Armistice Day was commemorated. In 1954, the U.S. Congress and President Dwight Eisenhower changed it to Veterans Day – a day to celebrate and honor all American veterans. MPII wishes to honor and thank all our residents that are Veterans – Happy Veterans Day!



November 23rd – Thanksgiving. With its beginnings as a thankful celebration of the harvest, Thanksgiving is now a favorite holiday of many Americans. With ties to family, friends, shared meals, and as the unofficial kickoff to the holiday season, all Americans generally enjoy Thanksgiving. MPII hopes all our residents, their families, and their friends have a very Happy Thanksgiving!

November is National Native American Heritage Month





Florida's history is inextricably linked with the good, the bad, and the ugly history of the interactions between early American settlers and the indigenous peoples. Florida remains home to over a dozen Native American tribes and is home to countless locations rich in that history. One location near us is Dade Battlefield Historic State Park in Bushnell. There is a small museum at the visitor center with information about the Seminole Wars as well as Dade's Battle of 1835. In January they perform a battle reenactment. For more information, use these links:

- https://www.floridastateparks.org/parks-and-trails/dade-battlefield-historic-state-park
- https://www.floridastateparks.org/events/dades-battle-1835-1

Upcoming EPC Events

The EPC, while still feeling great about their amazing Halloween Festival that so many of you enjoyed last month, is already busy with future events! The next big one will be the annual Meet & Greet with Santa. This is scheduled for Saturday, December 7th from 8:30 am – 12:30 pm. There will be free printed photos, refreshments, and entertainment! This event is a hit with families every year, so don't miss it!



Additionally, since so many MPII residents decorate their homes and yards for the holiday season, the EPC is hosting a new Yard of the Month competition for "Most Holiday Cheer". Submissions will be accepted from 11/6 – 12/6. The winner will be announced on 12/7 and will be featured in the January *MPII News*! The link to submit your home for the competition is https://forms.gle/2cSUKd1LYHqYC9gu7.



Also, the EPC has put together a great lineup of vendors for Food Truck Thursdays. On 11/7, the very popular Son of a Brisket is back in MPII. Then, on 11/14 *and* 11/21, Mimi's Meals and Munchies is here for back-to-back Thursdays. The last Thursday of November is Thanksgiving, so there will be no food truck that day.



Lastly, the EPC will be announcing a fun and innovative way for the community to get more connected! Check back in our December issue for details!

Holiday Schedules

As shocking as this may be to many of us, with Halloween behind us and the calendar's turn to November, that means holiday season is upon us! This also means it's time to make everyone aware of how some schedules will change during the next 10 weeks.

Firstly, Daylight Saving Time affects some schedules at the Clubhouse. Due to local laws, we will continue closing the pool, splash pad, and playground 30 minutes before dusk. Please bear in mind, due to the time change combined with shorter periods of daylight due to seasonal shifts, beginning on November 3rd, these closures will still occur earlier than previously, near 5 pm.

Additionally, the only three days of the year where the Clubhouse is closed are all approaching as part of holiday season (Thanksgiving Day, Christmas Day, and New Year's Day). So, on Wednesday, 11/27 the Clubhouse (all buildings) will close at noon, and we will reopen at normal hours on Friday, 11/29. Similarly, next month the Clubhouse will close at noon on Tuesday 12/24 and will reopen at normal hours on Thursday 12/26. One week later we will close at noon on Tuesday 12/31 and will reopen at normal hours on Thursday 1/2/25.

Also notably, while Coastal Waste and Recycling also closes those three days, both Christmas Day and New Year's Day this year fall on Wednesdays. Therefore, we do not anticipate any recycling pickups those two weeks throughout the nine villages that receive curbside service with Coastal. However, they may offer alternative pickups. At the time of this writing we do not have any information about that. It's also likely that they might be operating with smaller staff due to the holiday season, so let's all be patient with that as well. Remember, Coastal is available to answer questions and can be reached at 727-561-0360 or largocs@coastalwasteinc.com.

MPII Clubs & Opportunities



EC TENNIS ACADEMY offers tennis lessons to people aged 4 through adult. Contact Coach Edgardo Chavez at 813-328-0841.

TEACH LEAF is now enrolling for the Pre-K Learning Pod that begins in January for 4-5 year olds. Pod will meet on Tuesdays 10am-12 noon or 12:30-2:30pm. For more details or to enroll in either of these Pods please contact Melissa Goebel at teacher.melissa827@gmail.com.

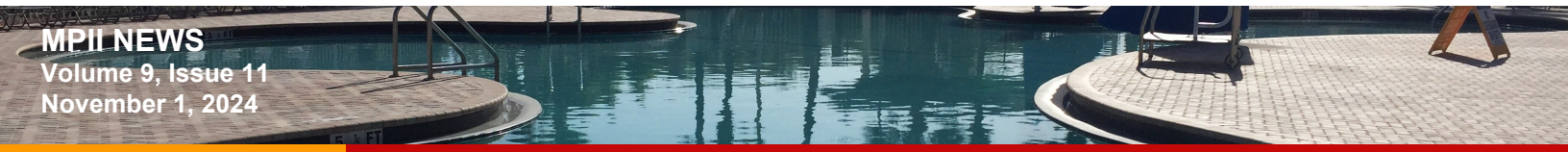
YARN CLUB meets every Thursday night from 6 – 8 pm. Open to all adults who knit or crochet – all skill levels welcome.



FREE FINANCIAL HELP is available from an MPII resident investment advisor! The next session is Thursday, November 21st at 7pm in the Clubhouse. Contact Pritam Dhavale at www.wealthcompoundersllc.com or 917-374-1576.

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MPII News Needs Your Photos!

If you have taken a photo within MPII that you think would make a nice cover shot on a future issue, please email it to newsletter@mpiicdd.org. Submitting a photo gives us permission to use it in the newsletter. If there are people in the photo, please ensure that we have their permission to publish their photo.

Also, remember that the Clubhouse has an opt-in email list for receiving the newsletter as a PDF each month! To opt-in, just email newsletter@mpiicdd.org and tell us what email address or addresses you'd like us to include. As of now, the Clubhouse only uses this list for the newsletter, but we may include other time-sensitive announcements in the future.